Activity 06 - Leader Coaching Huddle at NovaTech Services

Course: Mastering The Art of Conflict Resolution to Foster Team Collaboration and Success (TGS-2023021752) Duration: 60 minutes Materials: COACH planner | role cards | repair plan Output: A completed COACH conversation planner, observed coaching dialogue and two-week team repair plan.

Objective

Coach team members to prepare and own a constructive conflict conversation.

Psychological-safety boundary

Use only the fictional case. Do not require anyone to disclose a personal conflict. Any participant may call a pause or request another role. This learning activity does not replace organisational policy, HR advice or legal advice.

Scenario

At NovaTech Services, project lead Jordan feels that analyst Alex dismisses project decisions in meetings. Alex says Jordan closes discussion too quickly and uses seniority to override technical concerns. Department manager Taylor will coach Jordan first, not decide the dispute. Jordan must prepare a direct conversation that protects Alex's voice, clarifies decision rights and sets a follow-up checkpoint.

Detailed instructions

Role cards

Give each participant only their own role before the first round. Observers use the checklist.

Taylor | Coach

Goal: build Jordan's conflict capability. Private brief: Uses questions, reframing, rehearsal and clear escalation boundaries.

Jordan | Project Lead

Goal: restore respectful challenge and decision clarity. Private brief: Feels undermined but must examine own defensiveness and authority use.

Observer | Feedback Partner

Goal: assess coaching quality. Private brief: Checks neutrality, ownership, rehearsal and support plan.

1. Review the pattern. Read the NovaTech case and identify repeated team behaviours, work impact and what the leader may be reinforcing through action or silence.

2. Prepare the coach. Write the purpose, two observable examples, desired standard, open questions and the boundary between coaching and formal performance or grievance handling.

3. Contract. Begin by clarifying purpose, time, respectful participation and the shared responsibility to restore effective teamwork.

4. Observe. Describe specific behaviour and impact without motive claims. Invite the employee's account and correct any factual error.

5. Ask and listen. Use open questions, pauses, paraphrase and emotion acknowledgement to surface needs, barriers and system factors.

6. Create options. Ask the employee to suggest actions first; add leader support, team norms, workflow changes and a repair conversation where appropriate.

7. Hold commitment. Agree two observable actions, support, evidence of progress and a review date. State the consequence or escalation route if conduct persists.

8. Observer scores. The observer records evidence against listening, neutrality, specificity, accountability, psychological safety and follow-up.

9. Switch or replay. Rotate roles or replay the most difficult point using the observer's feedback.

10. Build the team plan. Translate individual commitments into a two-week team repair plan with owner, date, support and indicator for each action.

11. Debrief leader accountability. Identify one leader behaviour that must change so the plan does not place all responsibility on the employee.

Suggested timing

- 7 minutes - Case review and preparation
- 5 minutes - Contract and opening
- 10 minutes - Observed coaching dialogue
- 8 minutes - Options and commitments
- 5 minutes - Observer feedback
- 7 minutes - Replay
- 8 minutes - Team repair plan
- 5 minutes - Leadership debrief

Discussion questions

- Which questions help Jordan separate facts, feelings, assumptions and needs?
- What part of the conflict should Jordan own?
- How can Jordan invite technical challenge without reopening every decision?
- Which condition would require Taylor to move from coaching to formal action?

Submission

Submit the completed worksheet and checklist. Use role names rather than real personal data, mark unresolved information as unknown and retain the artefact only through the approved course channel.

Debrief

The coaching plan keeps ownership with Jordan while defining safe boundaries, rehearsal feedback and follow-up.